

Twilight years

Westmoreland retired from the Army in July 1972. His campaign for the Republican nomination for governor of South Carolina in 1974 was unsuccessful. In January 1982, CBS aired a documentary that accused Westmoreland and his staff of manipulating enemy counts to gain support for attrition. Westmoreland sued for libel in response. The long case brought renewed attention to the ethics of Westmoreland's leadership, and was eventually settled out of court.

Westmoreland devoted his retirement years to speaking opportunities and supporting veterans until Alzheimer's brought an end to his public life. He died in 2005, aged 91, and was buried at West Point Cemetery, New York.



Liked by his men

Westmoreland inspects the First Infantry Division in 1966. He was liked by troops, and aimed to be "respected" but not "loved" as he performed his command duty. In retirement, he tried to ensure that veterans were not criticized for their service in Vietnam.

“It was a **difficult war** against an **unorthodox enemy.**”

GENERAL WILLIAM C. WESTMORELAND, REFLECTING ON THE VIETNAM WAR, 1976